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September 25, 1972
SUPERSEDING
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May 15, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

STAPLER, BAG, HAND OPERATED

(STAPLER, BOX AND STAPLER, GENERAL USE) (AND STAPLES)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers hand operated plier design bag closing, box closing, and general use staplers and also staples.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Staplers. The staplers covered by this specification shall be the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - Plier stapler with fixed anvil arm.
Type II - Plier stapler with changeable anvil arms.

1.2.2 Staples. The staples covered by this specification shall be the following sizes (see 3.5.1) as specified (see 6.2).

Size 1 - 3/8 inch length of legs.
Size 2 - 1/2 inch length of legs.
Size 3 - 9/16 inch length of legs.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 3540
FSC 5315

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL-S-1970 - Staples and Tackers, Powered and Nonpowered: Preparation for Delivery.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130 - Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incoporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be those normally used in commercial practice.

3.2 Standard product. The staplers covered by this specification shall be the manufacturer's current standard product except for those modifications or changes required in order to comply with this specification. All accessories and components shall be furnished that are normally furnished with the standard product.

3.3 Stapler types.

3.3.1 Type I stapler. The type I stapler shall be identified by its frame which shall be constructed with the anvil arm as an integral part of the frame.

3.3.2 Type II stapler. The type II stapler shall be identified by its frame which shall be constructed with the anvil arm as a detachable component of the frame.

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3.4 Design and construction. The staplers covered by this specification are known commercially as plier type staplers or stapling pliers. The staplers shall consist essentially of a frame, driver arm, operating lever, staple channel, and staple follower. The stapler jaw opening (the distance between the anvil arm and the staple channel) shall be not less than 5/8 inch. The stapling range or throat depth between the jaws shall be not less than 2-3/4 inches. The assembly of the stapler components and parts shall be by means of welding, riveting, or the use of bolts, screws, and nuts as suitable for proper construction and operation.

3.4.1 Frame. The frame shall be made of steel not less than 0.062 inch thick. The driver arm, operating lever, and staple channel shall be attached to the frame by means of suitable hinge pins secured in the frame. The hinge pins shall be made of steel and shall have a Rockwell hardness of not less than 65, B scale and shall be not less than 3/16 inch in diameter at the bearing points. A finger grip suitable for applying the required operating pressure shall be a part of the frame construction. A finger guard shall be provided either as part of the frame or a separate loop attached to the frame. The finger grip and finger guard shall form a closed loop suitable for receiving the operator's fingers.

3.4.2 Driver arm. The driver arm shall be made of steel not less than 0.062 inch thick. The driver arm shall be provided with a suitable camming surface as an integral part of the arm for the bearing and passage of the operating lever roller in the stapling operation. The camming surface or the entire arm shall be suitably hardened to resist wear due to the passage of the roller. The arm shall be constructed with a notch or suitable stop which shall engage the operating lever roller to limit and maintain the stapler jaw opening as specified in 3.4. The arm shall be spring loaded in the direction to open the stapler jaws and force the arm against the operating lever at all times. The forward end of the arm shall contain the staple driver blade.

3.4.2.1 Staple driver blade. The staple driver blade shall be made of spring steel containing not less than 0.6 percent carbon and hardened equally over its whole length to a Rockwell hardness of not less than 48, C scale. The blade shall be mounted in the forward end of the driver arm and supported to permit it to shift on its mounting in order to operate in the vertical chute of the staple channel without any flexure.

3.4.3 Operating lever. The operating lever shall be made of steel not less than 0.062 inch thick. The operating lever shall be formed to provide a comfortable handgrip suitable for applying the required stapling pressure. A roller suitable for rolling on the camming surface of the driver arm and applying the stapling pressure shall be mounted in the operating lever.

3.4.4 Staple channel. The staple channel shall be made of steel not less than 0.050 inch thick. The staple channel shall receive staples with a leg length up to 9/16 inch and in strips up to 5-1/4 inches in length. The staples shall pass freely through the channel without binding or buckling of the staple strip. The forward end of the channel shall contain the vertical staple chute. The chute shall be either through hardened or the interior surfaces contacting the staples shall be case hardened. The top of the channel shall be open to provide visual inspection for determining the quantity of staples in the channel and to facilitate removal of jammed staples. There shall be an opening in the front end of the channel to further facilitate the removal of jammed staples. The channel shall be spring loaded in the direction to close the stapler jaws. The channel shall be held in the open jaw position by lugs on the driver arm, the spring load on the driver arm being sufficient to overcome the spring load on the channel.

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3.4.4.1 Staple follower. The staple follower shall consist of a latch with a suitable thumb and finger grip, a rod secured to the latch, a ram, and a helical spring on the rod between the latch and the ram. The ram shall be mounted on the rod and slide freely thereon. The spring load against the ram shall be sufficient to feed the staples to the vertical chute down to the last staple in a strip. There shall be no permanent deformation of the spring when the spring is deflected to its solid length. The latch shall engage the staple channel and be easily attached to and removed from the channel by means of the thumb and finger grip.

3.4.4.2 Staple channel spring. The staple channel spring shall be a flat spring made of spring steel containing not less than 0.60 percent carbon. The spring shall also serve to actuate the driver arm by transverse loading on the spring by the driver arm staple channel lugs. The installation and attachment of the spring shall be such that any point of flexure shall not develop fatigue and failure of the spring. The spring shall open the stapler jaws with a positive action following each stapling operation.

3.4.5 Anvils.

3.4.5.1 Anvil for type I stapler. The anvil for the type I stapler shall be a separate component secured to the anvil arm. The anvil shall form the standard clinch. The anvil shall be made of steel and be either hardened throughout or casehardened. The thickness of the case shall be not less than 0.010 inch and the hardness shall be not less than 85 (15-N-85) Rockwell superficial. Steel hardened throughout shall have equivalent hardness.

3.4.5.2 Anvils for type II staplers. For type II staplers, the anvil configuration shall be formed in the anvil arm. The anvil arm shall be a separate component and be attachable to the stapler frame by means of suitable screws. The anvil arm shall be made of steel not less than 0.1875 inch thick. The anvil portion of the arm or the entire arm shall be hardened or casehardened as specified in 3.4.5.1. One each of the anvil arms specified in 3.4.5.2.1 and 3.4.5.2.2 shall be furnished with each type II stapler.

3.4.5.2.1 Bagger anvil arm. The anvil end of the arm shall have a forked configuration suitable for accepting and holding the twisted end of a bag over the anvil. The staple shall be driven around the twisted end with a by-pass type clinch.

3.4.5.2.2 Sliver anvil arm. The anvil end of the arm shall be formed into a point and knife edges on the sides suitable for piercing fiberboard boxes and clinching staples on the inside of the box. The anvil shall form the standard clinch.

3.4.6 Depth guage. When specified (see 6.2), staplers shall be furnished with a depth guage. The depth guage shall be attachable to the anvil arm and be readily adjustable along the length of the arm to fix the reach of the arm at any predetermined length.

3.5 Staples. The staples furnished for use in the staplers covered by this specification shall be flat crown preformed staples with a chisel point at the ends of the legs. The staples shall be made of tinned, galvanized, or laquer finished steel wire of such quality and temper as to produce staples capable of proper penetration and clinching without buckling or fracturing of the staple crown or legs. The staples shall be cemented together in strip form with each strip consisting of not less than 105 staples of the staple wire width specified in 3.5.1. The cement shall be applied smoothly and shall set in a manner that the surfaces of the strips shall be free from tackiness. The cement shall not accumulate in the staple channel or in the channel vertical chute.

3.5.1 Staple dimensions. The staple dimensions shall be as shown in figure 1. The size of the staples shall be in terms of the length of the staple legs measured from the top of the staple crown.

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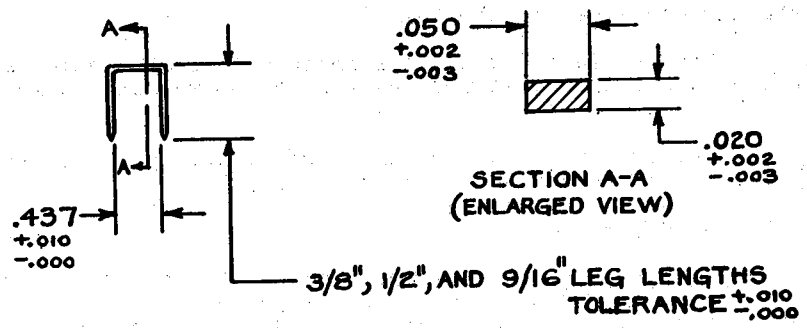


FIGURE 1. Staples

3.6 Performance. The staplers shall be capable of driving and clinching staples to a firm seat. The stapler shall be capable of all stapling operations by applying the grip and pressure of one hand. In each stapling operation the driving arm and staple channel shall depress as a unit until the staple channel contacts the anvil. The driver arm shall then further depress to drive the staple. When the hand pressure is released on the operating lever the stapler shall automatically return to its open position. The staple follower shall automatically advance the staple strip to place the next staple under the driver blade. Staplers with standard clinch anvils (see 3.4.5.1 and 3.4.5.2.2) shall be capable of driving and clinching staples through at least the following thickness of 16 pound sulphite bond paper:

Using 3/8 inch staples, 68 sheets.
Using 1/2 inch staples, 112 sheets.
Using 9/16 inch staples, 125 sheets.

3.6.1 Bag stapling. The type II stapler with the bagger anvil arm (see 3.4.5.2.1) shall be capable of stapling the ropelike twisted end of a bag by encircling and holding in a secure closure the twisted end with a staple.

3.6.2 Box stapling. The type II stapler with the sliver anvil arm (see 3.4.5.2.2) shall be capable of piercing fiberboard boxes and securely stapling the flaps of the box with the staples clinched on the inside of the box. The sliver anvil arm shall pierce the boxes in a clean manner without tearing the box material.

3.7 Finish. The staplers shall be painted or plated as specified (see 6.2). When painted, the staplers shall be finished with a durable paint or lacquer the color of which shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice unless otherwise specified (see 6.2). When plated, the plating shall be cadmium, chrome, or nickel.

3.8 Marking.

3.8.1 Staplers. Each stapler shall be permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. In addition, each stapler shall be marked with the size staples the stapler will accept. For military procurement, each stapler shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

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3.8.2 Boxes of Staples. Each box of staples shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined. In addition, each box of staples shall be marked with the size and quantity of staples contained in the box.

3.9 Instructions. The manufacturer shall furnish with each stapler an instruction sheet or pamphlet giving complete instructions for the operation and maintenance of the stapler.

3.10 Workmanship. The staplers shall be free from sharp edges, burrs, and slivers and any defects affecting appearance and serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105 except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, the contractor is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extend specified herein, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.2 End item inspection.

4.2.2.1 Staplers. A lot shall consist of all staplers of one type offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated stapler.

4.2.2.2 Staples. A lot shall consist of all staples of one size offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one box of staples.

4.2.2.3 Visual examination.

4.2.2.3.1 Staplers. The completely assembled end item shall be examined for defects in finish, construction, workmanship, and marking. Defects shall be as classified in table I. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for total defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects of staplers

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish	Type of finish not as specified.	X	
	Blistered, peeled, chipped, or area of no film.		X
Construction and workmanship	Part missing.	X	
	Any component cracked, fractured, or otherwise damaged affecting serviceability.	X	
	Any component defective or otherwise damaged but not affecting serviceability.		X
	Not connected or joined as specified; not in proper alignment.	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of defects of staplers (con't)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Construction and workmanship	Component loose.		X
	Any sharp edges, burrs, or metal slivers.	X	
Bolts, nuts, screws, and other types of threaded fasteners	Missing, broken, or threads stripped.	X	
	Loose.		X
Rivets	Broken, loose, not peened or insufficiently peened.	X	
Marking for identification	Missing, incomplete, not legible.		X
Instruction sheet or pamphlet	Missing, incomplete, not legible.	X	

4.2.2.3.2 Staples. The sample unit of staples shall be examined for defects in finish, construction, workmanship, and marking. Defects shall be as classified in table II. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of defects of staples

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Finish	Type of finish not as specified.	X	
	Blistered, peeled, chipped, or area of no film.		X
	Any area of rust or corrosion.	X	
Construction and workmanship	Crown not flat, legs not square with crown.	X	
	Ends of legs not formed to a chisel point.	X	
Cementing	Cement does not hold staples in a continuous strip.	X	
	Cement not applied smoothly.		X
	Staples not free from tackiness.	X	
Marking for identification (staple boxes)	Missing, incomplete, not legible.		X

4.2.2.4 Dimensional examination. Inspection shall be made of the end item to determine compliance with dimensional requirements. Any dimension that is not within the specified requirements shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be S-4 with an AQL of 2.5 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.5 Testing of the end item. One end item shall be selected from each lot (see 4.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2) and tested, as applicable, in accordance with 4.3. Any failure of an item shall be cause for rejection of the item and the lot from which it was selected.

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4.3 Test procedures.

4.3.1 Type I stapler. The type I stapler shall be tested by stapling the sheets of paper and in the quantities specified in 3.6 with the size staples specified. The stapler shall be loaded with full strips of staples as specified in 3.5 in the applicable sizes. Each thickness of the paper stack shall be stapled not less than 10 times. The driven staples shall be examined for proper and even penetration and proper and firm clinching. The stapler performance shall be observed to determine conformance to 3.6 during the stapling operations.

4.3.2 Type II stapler.

4.3.2.1 Test with the bagger anvil arm. The type II stapler with the bagger anvil arm installed (see 3.4.5.2.1) shall be tested to determine conformance to 3.6.1. The open end of a bag or the bag material shall be twisted into a ropelike shape in diameters suitable for proper securing by each of the three sizes of staples specified in 3.5.1. Each diameter of twist shall be stapled 5 times by the proper size staple and examination made to determine that the clinched staples provide a secure closure of the twist. The stapler performance shall be observed to determine conformance to 3.6, as applicable, during the stapling operation.

4.3.2.2 Test with the sliver anvil arm. The type II stapler with the sliver anvil arm installed (see 3.4.5.2.2) shall be tested to determine conformance to 3.6.2. Fiberboard or corrugated fiberboard boxes of material thickness suitable for proper stapling by each of the three sizes of staples specified in 3.5.1 shall be used for this test. The boxes shall be pierced by the sliver anvil arm and the box flaps stapled on all four sides, top, and bottom. Each of the three sizes of staples shall be used. The staples shall be examined for proper and secure clinch. The stapler performance shall be observed to determine conformance to 3.6 during the stapling operation.

4.3.3 Hardness of components. The contractors shall certify that the components of the stapler required to be hardened meet specified hardness requirements.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 Staplers. Each stapler shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with MIL-S-1970. Preservation and packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.2 Staples.

5.1.2.1 Levels A and B. Five thousand staples of one size shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, style VI.

5.1.2.2 Level C. The staples shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Staplers. Staplers, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-S-1970. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.2 Staples.

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5.2.2.1 Level A. Staples shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-591, class 2; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s. Wood and wood-cleated boxes shall be fitted with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547 with seams and closures sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Boxes shall be closed, sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit packages of staples, packaged as specified in 5.1.2, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, minimum grade 275. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.3 Level C. Staples, packaged as specified in 5.1.2.2, shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The staplers covered by this specification are intended for stapling by hand operation. The type I staplers are intended for general use in heavy duty stapling. The type II staplers are intended for stapling and securing the twisted ends of bags and for closing fiberboard boxes by stapling the box flaps with the staples clinched on the inside of the box.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following data in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of stapler required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Size of staples required (see 1.2.2).
(d) When a depth gauge is required (see 3.4.6).
(e) Whether staplers shall be painted or plated (see 3.7).
(f) Color of staplers if different from 3.7.
(g) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(h) Additional marking when required (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2).

CUSTODIANS

Army - GL
Navy - SA
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User Activities

Navy - YD, MC, CG

Review Activities

Army - GS, SM
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Preparing Activity

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